CHAPTER

11

FABRIC PREPARATION FOR SEWING

U97HFP

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- **To understand the method of making fabric straight to enhance marking and cutting patterns.**
- **To gain knowledge about various methods of marking, laying and cutting fabrics.**

11.1 INTRODUCTION

The market is flooded with huge variety of dress materials. Each varies in the type of fibre content, colour, design and type of finish. A clear knowledge about these concepts is needed to construct a good well fitted garment. Depending upon the type of fibre, the number of processes varies. Due to which the yarns may be treated with chemicals or pressure resulting the movement of yarns. Therefore, before stitching the garment, it should get adjusted to be straight. If we stitch the fabric without preparing it, then problems will arise in fitting. Example, when sewing in a fresh fabric, fit may be good but after one wash it will shrink in size. Due to that fitness may change, yarns may be reallocated and shape of the garment may change. So, it is necessary to prepare the fabric before marking and cutting it. There are different steps in fabric preparation. It varies upon the type of fabric used. The most important steps are shrinkage and straighten of grain.

11.2 GRAIN

Grain is the direction of the yarn in a fabric. In all woven fabrics, there are two set of yarns which interlace at right angles. The yarn which runs in the lengthwise direction is called warp, and the one which runs in crosswise direction is known as the weft. The warp yarns are known as lengthwise grain and weft yarns are called as crosswise grain. Length wise yarn is more strong and stiff. It is made with of higher twist yarn unlike the crosswise yarns.

Grain plays a very important role in garment designing and drape. The bodice blocks, skirt patterns are cut along the lengthwise grain (i.e., parallel to the selvedge). This ensures good drape and fall

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